preference to high words instead of quiet actions. Nehru understood the importance of maintaining a large military and he was not averse to the use of force as was demonstrated in 1948 in Kashmir and 1961 in Goa. Yet, he banked more on India's stature in global politics as insurance than on investing in Indian defence. Similarly, while Nehru knew the importance of a strong economy as the backbone of foreign policy, he created a paternalistic state apparatus that, over time, especially under Indira Gandhi, suppressed the growth of India's economy. This, in turn, meant that it was only with the liberalization of the economy in the 1990s that India was able to have the economic wherewithal to demand a seat at the global high table and also invest in its military apparatus.

Now, the primary objective of Indian foreign policy is to create a global environment that ensures India's economic development. While India's leaders continue to emphasize autonomy in decision making, the leverage obtained by India's deepening economic clout has ensured that it is easier for India today than it was in the early years after Independence. Narendra Modi has brought an activism to India's foreign policy that was missing for some time. In his first thirty-one months in office, Modi has travelled to forty-five countries including the United States, Japan, China, Australia, France, Germany, Brazil, the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and the United Kingdom.

Although they represent somewhat different outlooks, Modi is as passionate about foreign policy as Nehru. Modi conducts foreign policy with the help of a small group of advisers he trusts. He prefers to deal directly with his officers, instead of through their ministerial superiors, a practice similar to that of Nehru. He has also built a direct relationship with the Indian public, using both traditional media – his monthly *Mann Ki Baat* (literal translation 'Stray Thoughts') via radio – and modern instruments like social media; Modi has over twenty-nine million followers on twitter.